



World Food Programme

SAVING
LIVES
CHANGING
LIVES



WFP BURKINA FASO

COUNTRY BRIEF

May 2026

KEY HIGHLIGHTS

- **In April, WFP assisted 415,351 people**, delivering 3,590 mt of food. This reflects a slight decrease compared to March, mainly due to operational constraints, while efforts continued to reach vulnerable populations.
- **Humanitarian needs remain significant**, underscoring the importance of sustained assistance to protect vulnerable populations and consolidate recent gains.
- **WFP continues an integrated response** across food assistance, nutrition, school meals and resilience, requiring USD 99.6 million for May–October 2026 to sustain operations and avoid further deterioration in food security.

IN NUMBERS



415 351 people assisted in April 2026



57%
Male



43%
Female



3 590,28mt food distributed



USD 99.6 M (May – Oct 2026) net funding requirements

Photo Caption & Credit: WFP/Photographer Jecuthiel Yameogo

SITUATION OVERVIEW

- Burkina Faso faces a complex crisis driven by insecurity, climate shocks, and structural vulnerabilities. Reliance on rainfed agriculture heightens exposure to climate variability. Insecurity remains the primary driver of humanitarian needs, with 2 million internally displaced persons (latest official figure, March 2023), limiting access to land, markets, and essential services.
- The preliminary results from the April 2026 national food security and nutrition analysis projects 1.66 million people will face crisis-level food insecurity (IPC Phase 3+), including 223,000 people in emergency situations, during the June–August 2026 lean season, compared to 2.3 million in 2025. While the situation shows an overall improvement relative to last year, access constraints remain significant in several regions, despite localized progress observed in 2025 such as the restoration of access to Titao and Barsalogho.
- Already in 2025, funding shortfalls forced WFP to reduce its coverage by around 30 percent compared to 2024, contributing to deteriorating food consumption and increased negative coping strategies among vulnerable households. WFP continues to deliver an integrated response including emergency food and nutrition assistance, school feeding, resilience activities, and common services through UNHAS, supporting national efforts toward stabilization and food sovereignty.

OPERATIONAL UPDATES

General Food Assistance

- In April, WFP distributed over 2,907 mt of food and nutrition assistance to 197,404 people in localities such as Silmague, Seguenega, and Diapaga, including 180 mt airlifted to localities such as Kantchari or Gorgadji.
- WFP took part in two government-mandated convoys: one to Gayeri and another to Sebba and Solhan. WFP had last joined convoys to these locations in April 2025 and December 2024, respectively.
- The main challenge remains funding constraints, which limit WFP's ability to meet needs. In addition, two WFP airlift helicopters were unavailable due to operational and administrative constraints, significantly reducing airlift capacity and increasing reliance on road transport.

Nutrition

- WFP supported malnutrition prevention by assisting 855 young children and 553 women, while screening over 2,600 children and identifying very few cases of moderate malnutrition; nutrition awareness reached more than 4,300 people.
- To treat moderate acute malnutrition, WFP provided specialized nutritious foods to over 31,700 children and 15,600 women.
- WFP also strengthened local production of fortified foods through quality audits and training for national producers, improving standards and capacity.

School-Based Assistance

- In April, WFP reached 236,644 students (56 percent girls) with daily hot meals in 755 schools, including 7,259 students who received take-home rations (THR), to support attendance and retention.
- Under the integrated programme, 171,950 students (56 percent girls) in 629 schools received hot meals, with THR provided to upper primary students meeting attendance criteria. Under emergency school feeding, 64,694 students (54 percent girls) in 126 schools were assisted, including 34,484 IDPs, with support limited to on-site meals due to funding constraints.
- Efforts focused on programme quality and capacity strengthening (field monitoring, partnerships, kitchen construction), alongside coordination with partners and government, including Education

Cluster engagement and planning for the phase-out of emergency school feeding by end-2026.

Resilience and Livelihood Support

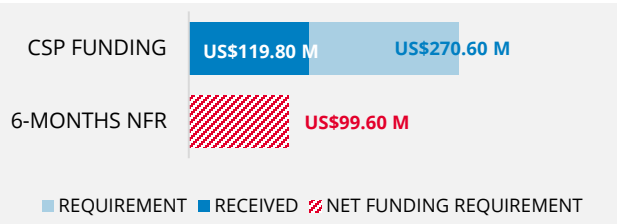
- In April 2026, WFP strengthened community resilience through the Food Assistance for Assets (FFA) programme, supporting the production of 185 compost heaps (9 m³ each), treatment of 17 gullies, and restoration of 86 hectares of degraded land. Activities also included the construction of 2,101 improved cookstoves, rehabilitation of 14 water ponds, seedling production, and assistance to 2,686 beneficiaries with 266 mt of food.
- Through the Smallholder Agricultural Market Support (SAMS) programme, WFP reinforced livelihoods by supporting farmer organization targeting and delivering SBCC messaging, while strengthening capacities through trainings of 40 participants (13 women) on GBV/PSEA and data collection, alongside project staff induction and technical workshops.

United Nations Humanitarian Air Service (UNHAS)

- In April 2026, UNHAS supported humanitarian operations through 246 flights to 27 destinations, serving 71 user organizations, and transporting 1,351 passengers as well as 22.9 mt of light cargo. Despite limited flight cancellations, UNHAS maintained access to isolated and hard-to-reach locations, including Bourzanga, Gorgadji, Arbinda, Djibo, and other remote areas.

FUNDING OVERVIEW

Country Strategic Plan (2019-2026)



Donors:

Donors to WFP's Burkina Faso Country Strategic Plan include **Austria, Burkina Faso, Canada, Denmark, the European Commission, Finland, France, Germany, Italy, Japan, Luxembourg, Monaco, the Netherlands, Norway, the Republic of Korea, the Russian Federation, Spain, Sweden, Switzerland, the United Kingdom and the United States of America.** Additional support was provided by the **UN Central Emergency Response Fund (CERF)** and private donors, including the **Ajram Foundation, Buddhist Global Relief, the Gwendolyn Sexton Foundation, and The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints.**